

FIFA World Cup 2026

Odds & Friendly Wagers — Setup & Deploy Guide

A sportsbook-style odds viewer for the 2026 World Cup, plus a private ledger for tracking friendly bets between friends. No real money moves through it — it records who bets whom using the live odds and settles who owes whom. It works immediately with sample odds; the three steps below switch on real live odds. The whole thing is free.

What you get

- Live odds — Match Winner, Total Goals, Handicap — best price across many bookmakers
- A wager ledger: log a bet between two friends using the live odds
- Players, each with a running net total
- Accumulator / parlay builder
- Open wagers (post one, a friend takes the other side)
- Head-to-head records across the tournament
- Settle-up screen that nets everyone to the simplest payments, copyable to your group chat
- Country theming on the live match

Everything saves on the one shared screen you use (a laptop or TV).

Try it right now (no setup)

Double-click **index.html** to open it in your browser. You will see **Sample Odds** (blue pill, top-right) and can test every feature. Live odds need the steps below.

Go live in 3 steps (about 5 minutes, free)

Step 1 — Get a free odds API key

- Go to **the-odds-api.com** and click “Get API key”.
- Sign up (no credit card). You receive a key like `a1b2c3d4 . . .`
- Copy it.

Step 2 — Put this folder online with Netlify

- Go to **netlify.com** and sign up (free).
- Click **Add new site** → **Deploy manually**.
- Drag this whole folder (**fifa-wc2026**) onto the upload box.
- Wait about 20 seconds for your live link (e.g. `your-site.netlify.app`). Rename it in Site configuration → Change site name.

Step 3 — Add your key (this turns on live odds)

- In Netlify, open your site → **Site configuration** → **Environment variables**.
- Click **Add a variable** → **Add a single variable**.
- Key: `ODDS_API_KEY` Value: *(paste the key from Step 1)*

- Save, then go to **Deploys** → **Trigger deploy** → **Deploy site**.

Open your live link — the pill should now read **Live** with odds from real bookmakers. Done.

Good to know

Refresh & free quota	The free plan gives 500 credits/month; each refresh costs about 3 credits. The app refreshes every 60 seconds. The pill shows credits remaining. For 30-second refresh, change REFRESH_MS in index.html to 30000, or upgrade the API tier.
Why 3 markets live	The free tier reliably returns Match Winner, Totals and Handicap. Deeper markets (player props, cards, corners, correct score) need a higher tier and can be added later without changing how anything looks.
World Cup sport key	If live odds ever come back empty, the season's key may have changed. Open netlify/functions/odds.js and follow the note at the top — a one-word change.
Your API key is safe	It lives only in Netlify's settings, never in the website code, so nobody visiting your link can see it.

Files in this folder

- **index.html** — the platform (the website itself)
- **netlify/functions/odds.js** — the small server that fetches live odds with your key
- **netlify.toml** — tells Netlify how to run it (no need to edit)
- **README.pdf / README.md** — this guide